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The Effect of Brand Heritage on Intention to Donate in Non-Profit Organizations: An Evaluation within the Context of Temporal Focus and Brand Trust

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ABSTRACT

This study investigates intention to donate to nonprofit organizations with the perspective of brand heritage, brand trust, and the temporal focus of donors. The study is conducted on the long-established Turkish nonprofit organization Kızılay. Data is gathered via an online survey ($n = 473$) with judgmental sampling. The findings indicate that the brand heritage of a nonprofit organization affects brand trust and intention to donate. Likewise, trust in a nonprofit organization positively influences donation intention. Brand trust partially mediates the relationship between brand heritage and intention to donate. While individuals' temporal focuses on the past and future moderate the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust, as expected, the present focus does not. The findings are expected to contribute to the branding processes and donation encouraging activities of nonprofit organizations.

KEYWORDS

Brand heritage; brand trust; intention to donate; nonprofit organizations; temporal focus

Introduction

The global non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and charities market was valued at approximately US\$255,705.9 million in 2019, with a growth of 4.4% since 2015, with more than 10 million institutions and organizations. The market is expected to reach a value of US\$ 294,313.5 million in 2023 (globe-newswire.com). Despite concerns that the COVID-19 pandemic would reduce donations to nonprofit organizations, donations in the US, which is one of the most prominent actors in the global charities and NGOs market, increased by 10.6%, with a 7.3% increase in the total number of donors in 2020 compared to the previous year (afpglobal.org/fepereports). According to the Annual Report on Philanthropy in America (2020), individuals, foundations, and companies have donated an estimated \$471.44 billion to more than 1.54 million charities in the United States (givingusa.org). Considering that the rate of donors who regularly subscribe to a donation program every month around the world is 45% and online donation behavior has increased by 12.1%

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(doublethedonation.com), it can be said that the market will continue to grow in 2023. It is also evident that the market has a growth potential due to increased corporate social responsibility, environmental awareness, and internet usage. As for the Turkish market, the sum of all individual aid and donations made during the year is estimated to be 17.6 billion TL as of 2018, according to the Individual Giving and Philanthropy Report (tusev.org). With these figures in mind, the efforts that actors in the market make to reach more donors and achieve higher donations are critically important. Nonprofit organizations that have successfully branded have significant advantages, such as motivating donors and volunteers to increase their commitment, retaining high-caliber employees and board members, justifying efforts to protect the brand, etc (Quelch et al., 2004).

Organizations that operate in a wide variety of fields, from health to education, from culture to arts, and from human rights to sustainable development with the aim of changing people's lives in a positive way without expecting any financial benefit in return are defined as nonprofit organizations (Nielsen, 1987). The increase in the number of these organizations and the increasing demand for a broader range of social services in recent years have led to a significant increase in the need for volunteers. In this regard, organizations' brand-oriented efforts are essential for their target audiences. Napoli (2006) found that the most successful nonprofit organizations tend to have more brand-oriented focuses. Brand-focused strategies have influenced the mind-set and tactical decisions of many nonprofit executives (Kylander & Stone, 2012). Brand heritage is one of these focuses. Creating heritage associations about a brand in the minds of consumers can evoke positive emotions about the brand (G. M. Rose et al., 2016). In addition, brand trust (G. M. Rose et al., 2016), brand credibility (Pecot et al., 2019), and the perceived value of a brand (Wuestefeld et al., 2012) are positively affected by brand heritage. Therefore, managers of relatively young organizations should attempt to reach the appropriate brand heritage by making connections with the organization's history. This may include connecting with heritage-rich groups and organizations, supporting local heritage and cultural events, or matching an organization's heritage with that of its philanthropists, volunteers, or founders (Curran et al., 2016). In addition, brand story elements such as the date of foundation, technology, and omni-temporality have been used to create brand associations by heritage brands (Pfannes et al., 2021).

Considering the importance of fundraising for nonprofit organizations with a clearer understanding of the role of branding in donor behavior, factors such as the brand heritage that these organizations have brought from the past to the present, and the public's trust in these organizations are critical elements. Mort et al. (2007) also emphasized that the essence of brand heritage in nonprofit organizations needs to be understood and requires the attention of researchers as a field of study.

Brand heritage is an environmental asset that plays a vital role for any organization, whether for-profit or not (Balmer & Balmer, 2013). On the other hand, there is no empirical study evaluating this vital role in the context of nonprofit organizations. The present study takes into account the dimensions of track record, longevity, core values, and use of symbols, which are put forward by Urde et al. (2007) as the foundations of brand heritage for nonprofit organizations together for the first time. Urde et al. (2007) introduce the concept of brand heritage from a business perspective. In this study, however, the brand heritage is conceptualized from the donor perspective of a nonprofit organization. Participants of the study evaluate a nonprofit organization's expertise and actions (track record), tradition (longevity), adherence to its corporate values (core values) and use of symbols.

The concept of brand heritage has been related to time. For instance, Pecot et al. (2019) conceptualize brand heritage as a temporal perception. Individuals may also pay varying amounts of attention to the past, present, and future. This distinction can be explained by the concept of temporal focus. Temporal focus, which may influence attitudes and behaviors and develops during childhood through interaction with classmates, teachers, and parents (Shipp & Aeon, 2019). In this study, instead of history important to the identity dimension in Urde et al. (2007)'s model, temporal focus of individuals is used in explaining brand heritage. The effect of brand heritage assessments on brand trust and intention to donate is expected to increase as donors' temporal focus increases. On the contrary, for donors with a low temporal focus, brand heritage associations of a nonprofit organization will be of relatively little value.

Brand trust's role as mediator and (past and future) temporal focus' role as moderator within the context of brand heritage in nonprofit organizations are examined for the first time in this study. In this regard, the present study is expected to contribute to the literature on brand heritage and nonprofit organizations.

Theoretical background and hypotheses development

Brand heritage

The idea that brands have heritage is based on the initial work of Smith and Steadman (1982), with the use of the historical perspective as a theme that supports the brand's image in advertisements (Hudson & Balmer, 2011). Brand heritage is characterized as a dimension of brand identity (Aaker, 2010). A brand having a performance that meets the past expectations of customers, its longevity, its continuity, and consistency over time, the use of symbols reflecting its past, and especially the organizational belief that history

is important for brand identity constitute the foundations of brand heritage (Urde et al., 2007).

However, these five pillars that explain the concept of brand heritage receive criticism for only reflecting the organization's perspective. Perspectives of managers, shareholders and customers on brand heritage may vary. For this reason, it is recommended to take customers or stakeholders into consideration while creating brand heritage communication studies (Rindell et al., 2015).

Components of the brand heritage model put forward by Urde et al. (2007), have been employed in brand heritage studies that consider consumer perceptions. In such studies, track record (Merchant & Rose, 2013; G. M. Rose et al., 2016; M. Rose et al., 2017), longevity (Merchant & Rose, 2013; Pecot et al., 2019; G. M. Rose et al., 2016; M. Rose et al., 2017) and use-of-symbols (M. Rose et al., 2017) dimensions have been evaluated by customers. Considering the uses in previous customer-focused studies, in this study, brand heritage can be defined as consumers' evaluation of the track record, longevity, use of symbols, and core values of a brand. Akin to previous studies, in this study, four facets of the brand heritage are examined from a consumer perspective.

Brand heritage can be used to create connotations by having a strong point-of-difference that can distinguish the brand from competing brands (Keller, 2013). Since competitors cannot easily imitate, using brand heritage as a positioning tool can provide companies with a competitive advantage against emerging brands. Furthermore, it increases the brand's value for customers and strengthens customer relations by providing origins and originality. The strong heritage of a brand makes it easier for the business to find new employees and retain existing ones (Curran, 2017).

Customers' confidence in the future weakens during periods of economic hardship. Under such unpredictable and harsh conditions, consumers look for products to feel safe. The use of brand heritage responds the consumers' search for safety (Hakala et al., 2011). Brands with high levels of heritage perception increase customers' perceptions of quality and allow both existing and new companies in the market to set higher prices (Pecot et al., 2018).

Brand heritage creates a link between the past, present, and future. Customers' perceptions of a brand's heritage could be examined in three temporal dimensions. Brand stability, longevity, and adaptability form the basis of perceived heritage (Pecot et al., 2019). Marketing management that wants to utilize brand heritage can focus on one of these dimensions in line with the aims of the business. For example, a brand that wants to be perceived as innovative by its customers may attach significance to adaptability. On the other hand, a brand that has recently introduced many innovations to its customers can benefit from these innovations in the long term by focusing on stability (Pecot et al., 2019).

However, the influence of the brand heritage on consumer behavior can vary. It is shown that brand heritage has a weaker effect on the intention to purchase products in individuals who seek personal growth and pleasure, place little value on safety, and avoid focusing on negative consequences (G. M. Rose et al., 2016). Therefore, brand heritage in brand positioning is expected to positively affect the purchasing behavior of more risk-averse individuals.

Although using a brand as a heritage object generally has positive results, some customers feel skeptical about it and may even resist it (Mencarelli et al., 2020). Furthermore, heritage brands can be perceived as old-fashioned in products aimed at children, adolescents, and young adults. In durable consumer goods and high-technology product categories, some consumers may perceive heritage brands as incompetent and outdated in innovation (Aaker, 2010).

Research on the phenomenon of brand heritage in nonprofit organizations (Curran et al., 2016) appears to be quite limited. Therefore, this study investigates brand heritage in the nonprofit organizations context by donors' perspective. More specifically, this research examines not the brand heritage of nonprofit organizations but rather the donors' perceptions of the brand heritage of nonprofit organizations.

Brand trust

In terms of brands, the phenomenon of trust can be based on the theory of brand personality. Brands having various personality traits like individuals can lead consumers to trust specific brand clusters, similar to how they trust people in their daily lives (Belaid & Temessek Behi, 2011). Since trust between parties is an essential phenomenon from the perspective of relationship marketing, the first studies on trust in the field of marketing focused on this area. The ultimate goal in marketing is to establish a strong bond between customers and the brand. Brand trust is generally thought to play a critical role in creating such a bond in the relationship (Delgado-Ballester & Luis Munuera-Alemán, 2001; Morgan & Hunt, 1994). Over time, the concept of brand trust has been examined in terms of consumers and businesses. These studies discuss several constructs to create brand trust, such as brand image, customer satisfaction, and perceived quality. Additionally, studies have revealed that brand trust positively affects customer loyalty, customer acceptance of brand extensions, and brand equity (Koschate-Fischer & Gartner, 2015).

One of the most cited definitions of brand trust was made by Chaudhuri and Holbrook (2001). According to this definition, brand trust is “*the willingness of the average consumer to trust a brand's ability to perform the specified functions*” (Chaudhuri & Holbrook, 2001, p. 82). Munuera-Aleman et al.

(2003) define brand trust as “*Strong expectations about the reliability and intentions of the brand in situations that involve risk for the consumer*” (Munuera-Aleman et al., 2003, p. 37). This definition conceptualizes brand trust as a phenomenon that consists of two dimensions: brand credibility and brand intentions. Brand credibility is based on consumers’ belief that the brand will deliver on its value proposition. On the other hand, brand intentions are based on the belief that the brand will protect the consumer’s interests when unexpected problems arise during the consumption of the product.

From a nonprofit organization perspective, building trust with donors is essential. Trust is the strongest indicator of the relationship between the nonprofit organization and the donor (Wiggill, 2014). However, a large number of studies have examined the relationship between trust and giving behaviors by donors, and the results have varied substantially. A meta-analysis study showed that organizational and sectoral trust were more strongly associated with giving than generalized or institutional trust (Chapman et al., 2021). Donations are made with a broad promise created by the mission and brand of nonprofit organizations instead of their performance in a particular activity (Bryce, 2007). Due to the fact that the provided services are intangible and the nonprofit organization’s activities are generally not evaluated by the donors with objective criteria requires donors to trust the promises made by the organization (Sargeant et al., 2006). Brand trust in nonprofit organizations is affected by individual-related (attitude toward philanthropy) and contextual (service quality) variables (Sargeant & Lee, 2002). An organization’s size, importance to the nation, reputation, transparency in reporting, and awareness increase trust in the organization (Furneaux & Wymer, 2015). Studies conducted on trademarks reveal that brand heritage positively affects brand trust (G. M. Rose et al., 2016; Wiedmann et al., 2011; Zeren & Kara, 2020). Hypothesis 1 is hypothesized with the assumption that such a relationship may also be valid in nonprofit organizations.

H1: Brand heritage positively affects brand trust in nonprofit organizations.

Intention to donate

Donations and aid are seen to have an important place among nonprofit organizations’ sources of income. For this reason, nonprofit organizations compete with each other in order to collect donations from donors and ensure the sustainability of the business (Omura & Forster, 2014).

Donation behavior emerges depending on the individual characteristics of the donors and the activities of nonprofit organizations.

Donation behavior is associated with many personal factors, such as showing empathy, having warm relationships with others (Webb & Wong, 2014), religiousness, and self-construal (Skarmeas et al., 2011). Additionally, nonprofit organizations informing donors about their activities, providing entertaining content, and being credible can positively affect donor behavior (Florenthal et al., 2020). Reporting to the donors that their donations are used for those in need creates positive feelings in them and increases their intention to donate again in the future (Merchant et al., 2010).

Studies on brand trust and purchase intention (Alif Fianto et al., 2014; Becerra & Badrinarayanan, 2013; Chae et al., 2020) reveal the positive effect of brand trust on intention. With respect to nonprofit organizations, brand trust is also an essential prerequisite for developing strong brands. Indeed, building trust that the nonprofit uses donations for its cause is one of the most important factors affecting donation behavior (Aytaç & Çarkoğlu, 2019). Generally, donors have to rely on the nonprofit organization due to the intangibility of the service provided by the organization and donors' lack of objective evaluations regarding whether or not donations will be used for the cause (Sargeant & Lee, 2004). Accordingly, trust in a nonprofit organization positively affects individuals' intention to donate (Alhidari et al., 2018; Bilgin & Kethüda, 2022; Goktas et al., 2019; Ha et al., 2022; Schultz et al., 2019). Hypothesis 2 is hypothesized based on previous findings in the literature.

H2: Brand trust in nonprofit organizations positively affects the intention to donate to these organizations.

Brand heritage can have a positive effect on consumers' intention to purchase products (G. M. Rose et al., 2016; Yaqub et al., 2020). In terms of nonprofit organizations, heritage brands that are perceived to have carried out their past activities properly and successfully (track-record dimension) are more likely to raise donations. Moreover, in donor perspective use of symbol dimension of brand heritage is about brand knowledge. An increase in the salience of a nonprofit organization's brand positively affects donation intention (Gregory et al., 2020). In addition, the longevity of a nonprofit might create nostalgic associations in the memories of donors. Nostalgia is shown to positively influence donation intention (Ford & Merchant, 2010). Hence, the present study examines the effect of nonprofit organizations' brand heritage on intention to donate. Hypothesis 3 is hypothesized accordingly.

H3: The brand heritage of nonprofit organizations positively affects individuals' intention to donate.

According to the Brand Resonance Model, brand heritage is one of the brand imagery associations that can be used by brands. Such associations might influence consumer judgments (such as credibility) and feelings regarding brand. Eventually, consumers form diverse types of loyalty to the brand. With regard to nonprofit organizations, stronger heritage associations generate trust. In addition to having a direct influence on intention to donate, brand heritage might indirectly increase donation intention via brand trust. A study on airline companies (Zeren & Kara, 2020) revealed that brand heritage affects brand purchase intention through brand trust and brand loyalty. The present study examines the mediating role of brand trust in brand heritage's effect on the intention to donate to nonprofit organizations. Hypothesis 4 is hypothesized accordingly.

H4: In nonprofit organizations, brand trust mediates the effect of brand heritage on the intention to donate.

Temporal focus

Individuals differ in their attention to the past, future, and present. Some people might focus on the memories and experiences they had in the past. On the other hand, some individuals may concentrate on what they will do in the future. Individuals' temporal perspective has been conceptualized in various studies. One of the most frequently used conceptualizations on this subject has been the Zimbardo Time Perspective Inventory (ZTPI). According to Zimbardo and Boyd (1999), individuals' time perspective can be evaluated in five dimensions (past-negative, past-positive, present-hedonistic, present-fatalistic, future). Past-negative items are about the individual's negative evaluations of the past. In contrast, the past-positive factor mainly focuses on the positive and nostalgic past. The present-hedonistic dimension indicates a risk-taking attitude toward time and life. The present-fatalistic items, however, are related to a helpless and pessimistic attitude toward the future and life. The future factor is described by the planning and achievement of future objectives.

Zimbardo and Boyd (1999) utilize the expression "temporal orientation" to describe individual viewpoints on time. Moreover, the temporal orientation approach suggests that individuals have a dominant perspective of time. Akin to temporal orientation, Shipp et al. (2009) propose the concept of temporal focus. The concept of temporal focus is defined as "the allocation of attention to the past, present and future" (Shipp et al., 2009, p. 2). According to Shipp et al. (2009), individuals may have more than one-time frame of focus and could shift their attention between

different time periods. At one extreme, individuals who focus highly on all three time periods are called “hypertemporal,” whereas those who don’t focus highly on any time are called “atemporal” (Shipp et al., 2009, p. 7).

The concept of temporal focus has been investigated under employability (Cerdin et al., 2020), managerial psychology (Tuncdogan & Dogan, 2019), consumer behavior (Cruz-Cárdenas et al., 2021; Tan et al., 2019) and corporate philanthropy (Nguyen et al., 2021). Individual temporal focus might affect how information is encoded and retrieved from memory, how goals are used, and how expectations are formed, among other cognitive processes (Zimbardo & Boyd, 1999). Previous studies have revealed that the level of temporal focus may have an influence on an individual’s attitude, behavior, and decision-making processes (Shipp et al., 2009). For example, the features that customers desire in a business loyalty program may differ depending on their temporal orientation. While past-focused consumers value traditions and rituals, present-focused individuals seek immediate benefits from loyalty programs (Hendler et al., 2022).

When it comes to the link between nostalgia, temporal focus, and brand heritage, Merchant and Rose (2013) state that nostalgia is one of the several antecedents of brand heritage, and vicarious nostalgia impacts brand heritage, leading to stronger brand attachment. Several conceptualizations of brand heritage (Rindell et al., 2015; Urde et al., 2007) emphasize that brand heritage is related not only to the past but also to the present and future of a brand’s identity. Rindell et al. (2015) further extend the concept of brand heritage with a consumer perspective and stress the importance of customers’ awareness of time spans and key time periods regarding a company’s brand heritage. This perspective is company-specific and focuses mainly on the past. Temporal focus, however, is a more general personality characteristic and deals with individuals’ past, present, and future focus.

One of the dimensions mentioned in Urde et al. (2007)’s corporate brand heritage model is *history important to identity*. Namely, a heritage brand’s past actions and values influence its present and future. The authors further elaborate on this notion and give the example of a Swiss watch company that uses the company’s chronological history for advertising purposes. In this paper, consumer-oriented perspective on brand heritage uses individual temporal focus instead of the concept of *history important to identity*.

Construal Level Theory posits that when the psychological distance between an entity and an individual increases, the individual tends to form more abstract construals regarding the entity (Trope & Liberman, 2010). Conversely, a decrease in the conceptual level results in more concrete and detailed thinking by the individual about the entity. Construal Level Theory proposes that psychological distance might consist of temporal distance, spatial distance, social distance, and hypothetical distance. In comparison to

low-level ones, high-level construals are more abstract, coherent and super-ordinate representations (Trope & Liberman, 2010).

By and large, studies indicate that present-focus and orientation is mostly related with short-term actions and decisions. Present-oriented consumers react discounts more positively than future-oriented consumers. That is, the effect of discount size on perceived product quality, perceived financial risk and purchase intention is moderated by individual temporal orientation (Mukherjee et al., 2017). In addition, future-focused customers like advertisements, which display forthcoming goods and emphasize key product features. Present-focused consumers, however, favor near-future advertisements that emphasize secondary product features (Martin et al., 2009). Present-oriented customers have a stronger favorable purchase intention and brand attitude when the cause-related marketing advertisement incorporates the proximal rather than distant company response (Tangari et al., 2010). However, such study indicates no significant change for future-oriented consumers. Similarly in a social media advertisement study, it is shown that using low emotionally intense emojis (low construal level) may result in higher purchase intentions for present-oriented consumers (Huang et al., 2022). The influence of temporal distance (short-term vs long term) in ad also is shown to have varying degrees of buying intention regarding smart glasses between present and future oriented individuals (Balbo & Jeannot, 2015). Compared with present-oriented consumers, future-oriented consumers are more likely to positively evaluate energy-efficient products when savings are positioned in the far future rather than the near future (Tangari & Smith, 2012).

Using brand heritage elements in advertisements may give rise to an increase in construal level of the brand (Scarpi, 2021). Therefore, authors anticipate no influence of present focus on the effect of brand heritage. On the other hand, Pecot et al. (2018) suggest that when evaluating a branded product, the consumer's past focus may be important to the impact of brand heritage. Indeed, their study confirms that consumer past focus might play a moderating role in the influence of brand heritage on brand consistency.

Future orientation is shown to influence positively social behaviors. For instance, future orientation plays a moderator role on the link between individual cultural orientation and prosocial giving (Hong & Byun, 2020). Future orientation also decrease the influence of social exclusion on prosocial behavior (Baorui et al., 2022). According to Meyer and Orth (2023), however, since the phenomenon of brand heritage is mostly related to the past, its effect on attitudes and behavior may weaken when individuals' future focus increases. By using the stereotype content model, it is shown that the influence of brand heritage on warmth and competence is negatively moderated by individual future focus for wine and hotel brands (Meyer & Orth, 2023). In the context of nonprofit brands, brand heritage may provide positive cues for donors regarding the nonprofit's success in dealing with unexpected future

events such as earthquakes and floods. As a result, drawing on the previous literature and the construal level theory, past and future temporal focus is thought to strengthen the effect of brand heritage on brand trust. Present focus, however is anticipated to have no influence on the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust. The following hypotheses are developed accordingly:

H5: Individuals' past focus moderates positively the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust.

H6: Individuals' future focus moderates positively the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust

H7: Individuals' present focus does not moderate positively the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust.

Methodology

Design, sampling, and data collection

In order to test the hypotheses, a cross-sectional research design is used. Data is collected regarding Kızılay (Türkiye Red Crescent) organization using the judgmental sampling method via an online questionnaire. Kızılay is a Türkiye-based nonprofit organization that has been active since 1868. Kızılay's mission is defined as taking a proactive role in providing assistance to the needy and the vulnerable, improving cooperation in society, providing safe blood, and reducing vulnerability during disasters and in ordinary times (www.kizilay.org.tr). Considerations such as the fact that the organization has a relatively long and deep-rooted history, leading it to be more prone to evaluations in terms of brand heritage among the participants, are influential for choosing the Kızılay case for the study. For instance, Kızılay Week is celebrated between October 29 and November 4 in schools in Türkiye. During this period, students are informed in schools about the history and activities of Kızılay.

Covariance-based structural equation modeling and confirmatory factor analyses are carried out in order to test the research hypotheses and evaluate the validity of measures. A minimum number of 10 cases is suggested per indicator to carry out such analyses (Kline, 2011). The questionnaire included 43 scale items. As a result, data is collected with the aim of exceeding 430.

Data is gathered via online questionnaires created in Google forms. The survey form was shared on the researchers' social media accounts. The data collection process continued throughout June and July 2021. For ethical

Table 1. Demographic profiles of respondents.

Gender	Male (49.8%) Female (50.2%)
Age	18–25 (27.8%) 26–35 (41.6%) 36–45 (17.6%) 46–55 (10.3%) 56 or above (2.7%)
Level of education	High school or under (20.1%) College (11.9%) Undergraduate (46.4%) Masters level (15.5%) PhD (6.1%)
Income	3000 TL or under (36%) 3001–6000 TL (34.7%) 6001–9000 TL (18.4%) 9001 TL or above (10.9%)

purposes, only participants over 18 years of age are allowed to submit responses. Therefore, a judgmental sampling procedure is used. Respondents whose consent is obtained participate in the study voluntarily without receiving any sort of incentive. 478 completely filled questionnaires are obtained at the end of the data collection process. 65.9% of the participants had donated to Kızılay. [Table 1](#) summarizes the demographic characteristics of the participants of this study. The study was approved by the Sivas Cumhuriyet University Social Sciences and Humanities Ethical Committee on May 5, 2022 (approval number: E-60263016-050.06.04 -168,771).

Measures

At the beginning of the questionnaire, respondents of the study are asked for their consent. Then, the opinions of respondents about Kızılay are asked. Kızılay's track record, longevity, core values, use of symbols, and brand trust are respectively evaluated by respondents. In the next part of the questionnaire, respondents are asked about their intention to donate to Kızılay. Then, the temporal focus of the participants is measured. Finally, questions about the demographic profiles of respondents are given. The scales used to measure the variables are shown in [Table 2](#). Two bilingual experts translate all items into Turkish and then back-translated into English. After this procedure, a pilot study is conducted on 30 respondents to detect any possible wording or measurement problems.

Results

Assessing the measurement model

This study measures nine latent constructs with 43 items. Confirmatory factor analyses are carried out using the AMOS 23 software to test the construct validity of the measurement instruments. The analyses are performed by using

Table 2. Constructs and scales.

Construct	Scale origin	Measurement level
Core values	The corporate values of Kızılay (Justice, Solidarity, Trust, Honor, Open Communications) are adopted by researchers. To what extent has Kızılay acted in accordance with these values in its policy and actions?	5-Point Likert (1: Not at all, 2: Minimally, 3: Moderately, 4: Severely, 5: Completely)
Track record	Gregory et al. (2020)	7-Point Likert (1: Strongly disagree, 2: Disagree, 3: Somewhat disagree, 4: Neither agree nor disagree, 5: Somewhat agree, 6: Agree, 7: Strongly agree)
Longevity	Pecot et al. (2019)	5-Point Likert (1: Strongly disagree, 2: Disagree, 3: Neither agree nor disagree, 4: Agree, 5: Strongly agree)
Use of symbols	M. Rose et al. (2017); Foroudi et al. (2014)	
Brand trust	Sargeant et al. (2006)	
Intention to donate	Merchant et al. (2010)	
Temporal focus	Shipp et al. (2009)	7-Point Likert (1: Never, 3: Sometimes, 5: Frequently, 7: Constantly)

the maximum likelihood estimation method. The CFA results showed a significant chi-square ($X^2 = 2508.446$, d.f. = 704, $p < .000$) for the measurement model. Furthermore, the other fit indices ($X^2/\text{d.f.} = 3.563$; RMSEA = 0.073; NFI = 0.90; CFI = 0.925; SRMR = 0.051) are calculated. On the whole, there is an acceptable fit between the measurement model and the data.

Standardized loadings of the indicators are given in Table 3. For a good convergent validity, it is suggested that the factor loadings of each item exceed 0.5, the composite reliabilities of the scales be at least 0.7, and the average variance extracted (AVE) values of each scale be greater than 0.5 (Hair, 2014). As shown in Table 3, all factor loadings exceed the 0.70 threshold. Furthermore, composite reliabilities of the scales are within the 0.89–0.97 range. Besides, the present focus scale has the smallest AVE value, with 0.68. These findings indicate a good convergent validity for the scales of the study.

Table 4 shows correlations among the constructs of the study. The discriminant validity of the measures can be examined by comparing correlations and the square roots of the measures' AVE values. If the correlation coefficient between two constructs is lower than the square root of each construct's AVE value, there is a discrimination between the two constructs (Hair, 2014). In Table 4, it can be seen that all correlations are lower than the square roots of the AVE values. As a result, there is adequate discriminant validity among the measures of the study.

Assessing the structural model

In order to test the research hypotheses, the structural equation model is analyzed in AMOS 23 via the maximum likelihood estimation method. The results show that there is an acceptable fit ($X^2 = 1404.697$, d.f. = 340, $p < .001$; $X^2/\text{d.f.} = 4.131$; RMSEA = 0.081; NFI = 0.92; CFI = 0.94; SRMR = 0.062)

Table 3. Convergent validity of scales.

Scales	Std. loadings
Track record (C.R. = 0.97, AVE = 0.82)	
Kızılây has a good reputation	0.90
Kızılây appears professional	0.92
Kızılây is an expert in the field	0.93
Kızılây knows a lot about dealing with need	0.94
Kızılây is likely to have an impact on its cause	0.94
Kızılây acts in the best interest of those in need	0.89
Kızılây uses donations appropriately	0.87
Kızılây has a good track record of delivery	0.88
Longevity (C.R. = 0.92, AVE = 0.76)	
Kızılây exudes a sense of tradition	0.90
Kızılây is a brand that reinforces and builds on long-held traditions	0.83
Kızılây is a brand with roots	0.88
Kızılây is a brand that has a strong link to the past	0.88
Core values (C.R. = 0.95, AVE = 0.80)	
Justice	0.91
Solidarity	0.87
Trust	0.94
Honor	0.93
Open Communications	0.83
Use of symbols (C.R. = 0.91, AVE = 0.74)	
The symbols of Kızılây are associated with the heritage of the organization	0.78
I know the colors of Kızılây	0.82
Kızılây's logo is meaningful	0.94
Kızılây's logo communicates what the organization stands for	0.90
Brand trust (C.R. = 0.96, AVE = 0.88)	
I would trust Kızılây to always act in the best interest of its cause	0.94
I would trust Kızılây to conduct their operations ethically	0.95
I would trust Kızılây to use donated funds appropriately	0.94
I would trust Kızılây not to exploit their donors	0.93
Intention to donate (C.R. = 0.96, AVE = 0.89)	
I am likely to donate Kızılây in the future	0.96
I will donate to Kızılây next time	0.95
I will definitely donate to Kızılây in the future	0.93
Past focus (C.R. = 0.93, AVE = 0.78)	
I replay memories of the past in my mind	0.82
I reflect on what has happened in my life	0.87
I think about things from my past	0.95
I think back to my earlier days	0.90
Present focus (C.R. = 0.89, AVE = 0.68)	
I focus on what is currently happening in my life	0.84
My mind is focused on the here and now	0.90
I think about where I am today	0.79
I live my life in the present	0.79
Future focus (C.R. = 0.94, AVE = 0.81)	
I think about what my future has in store	0.98
I think about times to come	0.98
I focus on my future	0.84
I imagine what tomorrow will bring for me	0.79

C.R.=composite reliability, AVE=average variance extracted.

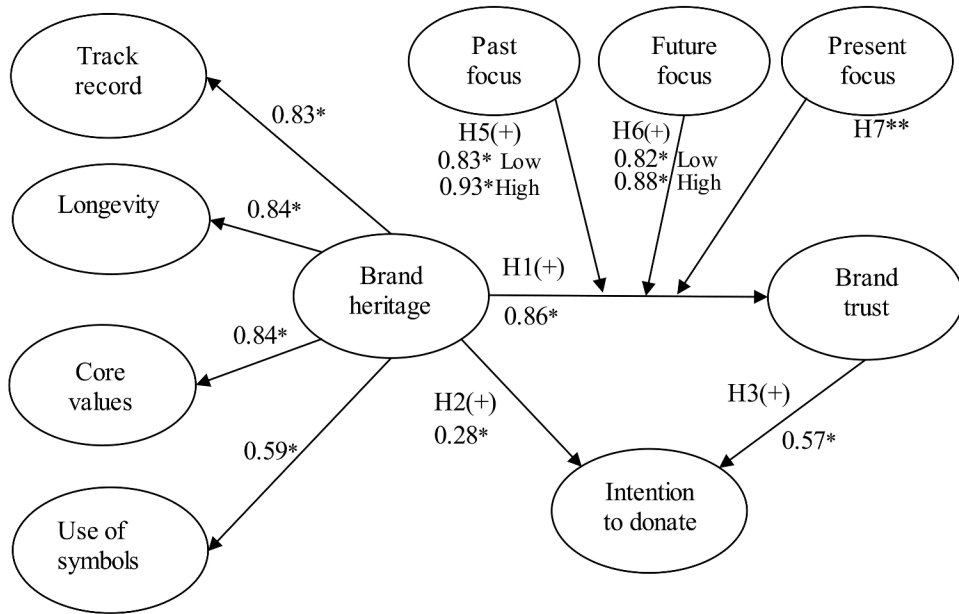
between the structural model and data. Brand heritage and brand trust are shown to explain 69.5% of the variation in intention to donate. In addition, the squared multiple correlation coefficient of brand trust is calculated to be 0.739. Figure 1 shows the results of the structural model.

The results support the claim that brand heritage is positively associated with brand trust (standardized $\beta = 0.859$, $p < .01$). Respondents have a higher

Table 4. Intercorrelations between constructs of the study.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Track record (1)	0.90								
Longevity (2)	0.76	0.87							
Core values (3)	0.68	0.64	0.90						
Use of symbols (4)	0.49	0.65	0.44	0.86					
Brand trust (5)	0.72	0.64	0.80	0.45	0.94				
Intention to donate (6)	0.64	0.61	0.71	0.44	0.82	0.95			
Past focus (7)	0.28	0.42	0.37	0.42	0.32	0.35	0.89		
Present focus (8)	0.26	0.42	0.37	0.40	0.33	0.32	0.56	0.83	
Future focus (9)	0.24	0.31	0.33	0.37	0.27	0.30	0.64	0.65	0.90

Numbers given in bold are square roots of AVE values.



* $p < 0.01$

**No moderating effect

Figure 1. Structural model.

perception of a nonprofit organization's heritage leads to higher trust in said organization. As in previous studies, hypothesis 1 is supported. Likewise, the findings also indicate a positive association between brand heritage and intention to donate to the nonprofit organization (standardized $\beta = 0.285$, $p < .01$). Therefore, this evidence supports hypothesis 2. Furthermore, the results show a positive association between brand trust and intention to donate (standardized $\beta = 0.575$, $p < .01$). Building a strong brand trust appears to increase the donations of a nonprofit organization. Hypothesis 3 is therefore supported.

A bootstrap is performed in AMOS with 5000 samples in order to test hypothesis 4. Both the direct (standardized $\beta = 0.285$) and indirect effects

(standardized $\beta = 0.494$) of brand heritage on intention to donate are shown to be statistically significant ($p < .01$). As a result, it is concluded that brand trust partially mediates brand heritage's effect on the intention to donate. Therefore, hypothesis 4 is supported.

The study sample is split into two groups based on the temporal focus items with the K-Means clustering method to test the moderation hypotheses. The results show that 247 respondents are in the low past focus group (total past score mean = 16.92), while 231 are in the high past focus group (total past score mean = 25.67). With regard to present focus, 177 participants are in low present group (total present score mean = 16.90). On the other hand, 301 participants are in high present group (total present score mean = 24.89). Besides, 112 participants are classified as low future focus (total future score mean = 14.44). 366 respondents are shown to be in high future group (total future score mean = 25.12).

Two models are estimated in order to test whether past temporal focus moderates the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust. In the first model, the path between brand heritage and brand trust is constrained, whereas the path is allowed to vary in the second model. There is a significant chi-square difference ($\Delta\chi^2_{(1)} = 8.36, p < .001$) between the unconstrained and constrained model fits. Therefore, the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust differs significantly in the two past focus groups. The relationship between brand heritage and brand trust in the low past focus group is significant and positive (standardized $\beta = 0.83, p < .01$). In the high past focus group, the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust appears to be stronger (standardized $\beta = 0.93, p < .01$). Past focus strengthens the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust. Therefore, hypothesis 5 is supported.

With regard to future focus, there is a significant chi-square difference ($\Delta\chi^2_{(1)} = 16.75, p < .001$) between the unconstrained and constrained model fits. The relationship between brand heritage and brand trust in the low future focus group is significant and positive (standardized $\beta = 0.82, p < .01$). The relationship between brand heritage and brand trust seems to be larger in the high future focus group (standardized $\beta = 0.88, p < .01$). The relationship between brand heritage and brand trust is strengthened by future focus. Consequently, hypothesis 6 is supported. [Figure 2](#) illustrates the moderating effects of past and future focus groups.

To test whether present focus moderates the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust, the constrained and unconstrained models are compared in terms of model fit. There is an insignificant chi-square difference ($\Delta\chi^2_{(1)} = 1.31, p = .25$) between the two present focus groups. Present focus has no effect on the relationship between brand heritage and intention to donate. Therefore, the findings of this study support hypothesis 7.

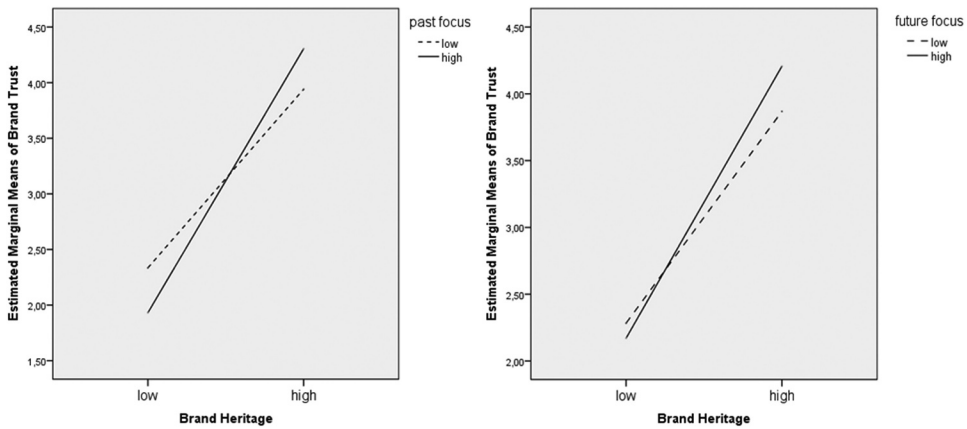


Figure 2. Moderating effects of past and future focus.

Discussion and conclusion

The findings of this study reveal that within the context of nonprofit organizations, brand heritage affects brand trust and intention to donate, and brand trust affects intention to donate. These findings are consistent with the current studies in the literature. The findings that brand heritage positively affects brand trust (G. M. Rose et al., 2016; Wiedmann et al., 2011; Zeren & Kara, 2020) are also supported within the scope of nonprofit organizations in this study. Similarly, brand heritage is also shown to affect the intention to donate to nonprofit organizations, as seen in studies (G. M. Rose et al., 2016; Yaqub et al., 2020) that demonstrate how brand heritage affects purchase intention for brands.

Not every brand that has a narrative on something from the past can have a heritage value. A deep bond of trust should be established with the consumers for this (Balmer & Balmer, 2013). This way, trust is critical for a brand with brand heritage to create an intention to donate. The results obtained in this study reveal that brand trust has a partially mediating effect on the relationship between brand heritage and intention to donate. Ha et al. (2022) revealed that brand-related factors (such as brand trust, brand familiarity etc.) have significant effects on behavioral intention. They also demonstrated that brand trust can be seen as a mediating variable in the context of branding process for nonprofit organizations. Therefore, nonprofit organization's efforts to create and maintain brand trust will be vital to influence intention to donate based on brand heritage. Because brand trust is a variable that convey the effect of brand heritage on the intention to donate. On the other hand, stronger heritage associations may generate and strengthen the trust. Thus, nonprofit organizations were suggested to consider utilizing brand heritage to enhance trust and thereby increase consumers' intention to donate.

Pecot et al. (2019) discussed the scope of brand heritage as a purely temporal concept based on a set of brand associations. Heritage is an element that carries something from the past to the present and later shapes future expectations (Rindell et al., 2014). In this respect, the temporal focus of consumers is important in terms of brand heritage. In this paper, Urde et al. (2007)'s conceptualization of brand heritage is modified by using temporal focus instead of history important to identity. Temporal focus is a variable that significantly influences different types of consumer responses, such as brand preference and willingness to pay under various conditions (Tan et al., 2019). Therefore, temporal focus can be evaluated as a moderating variable in terms of brand heritage and heritage-dependent variables. Regarding the results obtained in this study, while the individuals' temporal focuses on past and future have a significant effect on the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust, as expected, the focus on present does not. There are two past and two future groups, categorized as low and high. In the high past focus group, the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust appears to be stronger. Similarly, the relationship between brand heritage and brand trust seems to be more substantial in the high future focus group. In summary, the findings of this study revealed that consumers' temporal focuses can be utilized to develop relationship between brand heritage and brand trust. Therefore, nonprofit organizations that want to increase and strengthen brand trust through their brand heritage can target consumer profiles with a high past and high future temporal focuses. It can be suggested that nonprofit organizations consider using messages focused on past and future events to evoke the link between brand heritage and brand trust. For example, Kızılay's longevity might create nostalgic associations in the memories of donors. So, Kızılay may utilize messages focused on past via longevity to strengthen the link between brand heritage and brand trust. On the other hand, as Hendler et al. (2022) stated that past-focused consumers value traditions and rituals. If nonprofit organizations such as Kızılay, try to create shared traditions and rituals among communities, it could be beneficial for revealing the connection between brand heritage and brand trust. For future-focus consumers, it is suggested that using advertisements which display forthcoming or planning goods and services or how nonprofit organization (will) dealing with unexpected future events such as earthquakes, floods etc.

This study is expected to help nonprofit organizations determine whether they have brand heritage and make efforts to strengthen their brand heritage, create more resources, lead to more active participation by the volunteers (through donations as well as other volunteering activities), improve organizational performance, and develop other strategies that might lead to achieving competitive advantages.

Limitations and future research

Firstly, the study is conducted with participants reached online through judgmental sampling. It limits the generalizability of the findings. Furthermore, survey data is gathered partially from the members of Kızılay, specifically from the Kızılay brand, instead of several nonprofit organizations. Therefore, the findings should not be seen as clear evidence of any causal relationships but rather as an advancement of the theoretical understanding of brand heritage, particularly in nonprofit organizations.

Secondly, other brand heritage related factors, such as customers' perceptions of quality, which might have a moderation effect between brand heritage and intention to donate, can be considered in the future.

Lastly, the participants are offered no incentives due to financial constraints, leading to low participant interest in the survey. Therefore, future studies may provide participants with incentives and adopt research designs that allow for experimental designs or qualitative research instead of collecting data through surveys.

Disclosure statement

No potential conflict of interest was reported by the author(s).

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